

Galileo Galilei

The Sky Had More to Show

The true story of a boy who learned to test things, not just believe them, and grew up to build a telescope and find mountains on the Moon and moons around Jupiter.

Before reading

Look at the cover. What is young Galileo holding? What can you see in the sky?

While reading

1. What did Galileo's father measure when he played music?
2. How did Galileo time the swinging lamp in the cathedral?
3. What did Galileo see when he pointed his telescope at the Moon?

After reading

1. Galileo looked again and found something new. What could you look at again, more carefully?
2. Some people did not like Galileo's ideas. How do you think he felt? Why did he keep thinking?
3. If you had a telescope tonight, what would you look at first?

The big idea

Look. Measure. Look again!

Use it for anything: look at it, measure it (count, time or weigh it), then look again to see what you missed.

Try this together

A pendulum test. Tie a small toy to a string and let it swing. Count the swings in 10 seconds. Now try a longer string. What happens?

Words to talk about

telescope · lens · planet · moon · crater · measure

Tips for reading aloud: pause on the pictures and let children notice details first. There are no wrong answers to these questions; follow your child's curiosity. The back of the book has four simple experiments to try, and a free activity pack is at tarkasatales.com/activities.

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